

The Results



The refilled cartridge loses out on reproduction of detail (marked in the circled areas), but not too much



Note the level of detail in the circled areas, produced by the original cartridge—it's not so obvious; there's only a subtle difference



An image produced by the refilled cartridge. Note the slight difference in detail, as well as colour reproduction, when compared to the image on the right



The image produced by the original cartridge. Note that all colours—the blue, especially—have been rendered perfectly. Note also the level of detail in the flowers

Analysis

Our analysis looked at two aspects—performance and quality. In performance, we logged the time taken to print our test files. As seen in the results, the differences aren't significant.

Surprisingly, the refilled cartridges did better in most tests. In our opinion, ink characteristics such as viscosity, pigment concentration, etc. vary—hence the difference in the output.

Quality-wise, the results were rather

astonishing. There was hardly any difference between the two text printouts. The combi-document differences were significant, with the genuine cartridge yielding better sharpness and reproduction of details.

The refilled ink also took some seconds to dry on normal paper—the media that was used for most of the tests, except the photograph test. This characteristic—drying time—might be what's responsible for the differences in quality

between the two combi-document outputs, and in the performance figures.

The photograph test saw minimal differences, and these were restricted to tonal deviation. The near-perfect skin tone produced by the genuine cartridges was lost to some extent when the refilled ones were used. Barring this, there was hardly an error that we could point out.

Overall, the differences between the two cartridges were minimal (refer table alongside), and in everyday use, they'd hardly matter. Moreover, if you refill the cartridge twice—which is what we feel is the safest bet over buying new cartridges—you can easily save enough money to buy a new printer, rather than buying new cartridges, or refilling them for the third time! 

Tests	Quality (Scale of 5)		Time taken in seconds	
	Original cartridges	Refilled cartridges	Original cartridges	Refilled cartridges
Text printout—Normal	3.50	3.50	18	14
Text printout—Best	3.50	3.50	140	133
Combi-document—Normal	3.50	3.00	72	74
Combi-document—Best	4.00	3.00	148	150
Photograph—Best	3.50	3.25	395	388

SANKET NAIK

sanket_naik@thinkdigit.com